

FOR TEACHERS ONLY

The University of the State of New York
REGENTS HIGH SCHOOL EXAMINATION

ELA

ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS

Tuesday, January 20, 2026 — 9:15 a.m. to 12:15 p.m., only

RATING GUIDE

Updated information regarding the rating of this examination may be posted on the New York State Education Department's web site during the rating period. Check this web site at <https://www.nysed.gov/state-assessment/high-school-regents-examinations> and select the link "Scoring Information" for any recently posted information regarding this examination. This site should be checked before the rating process for this examination begins and several times throughout the Regents Examination period.

The following procedures are to be used for rating papers in the Regents Examination in English Language Arts. More detailed directions for the organization of the rating process and procedures for rating the examination are included in the *Directions for Scoring Regents Examinations*.

ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS

Mechanics of Rating

Scoring the Multiple-Choice Questions

For this exam all schools must use uniform scannable answer sheets provided by the regional scanning center or large-city scanning center. **If the student's responses for the multiple-choice questions are being hand scored prior to being scanned, the scorer must be careful not to make any marks on the answer sheet except to record the scores in the designated score boxes. Marks elsewhere on the answer sheet will interfere with the accuracy of the scanning.**

Before scannable answer sheets are machine scored, several samples must be both machine and manually scored to ensure the accuracy of the machine-scoring process. All discrepancies must be resolved before student answer sheets are machine scored. When machine scoring is completed, a sample of the scored answer sheets must be scored manually to verify the accuracy of the machine-scoring process.

Rating of Essay and Response Questions

- (1) In training raters to score student essays and responses for each part of the examination, follow the procedures outlined below:

Introduction to the Tasks

- Raters read the task and summarize it.
- Raters read the passages or passage and plan a response to the task.
- Raters share response plans and summarize expectations for student responses.

Introduction to the Rubric and Anchor Papers

- Trainer reviews rubric with reference to the task.
- Trainer reviews procedures for assigning holistic scores (i.e., by matching evidence from the response to the language of the rubric and by weighing all qualities equally).
- Trainer leads review of each anchor paper and commentary. (*Note:* anchor papers are ordered in pairs of high and low within each score level.)

Practice Scoring Individually

- Raters score a set of five practice papers individually. Raters should score the five papers independently without looking at the scores provided after the five papers.
- Trainer records scores and leads discussion until raters feel comfortable enough to move on to actual scoring. (Practice papers for Parts 2 and 3 contain score and commentary.)

- (2) When actual rating begins, each rater should record his or her individual rating for a student's essay and response on the rating sheets provided in the *Directions for Scoring Regents Examinations*, not directly on the student's essay or response or answer sheet. Do *not* correct the student's work by making insertions or changes of any kind.
- (3) Both the 6-credit essay and the 4-credit response must be rated by at least two raters; a third rater will be necessary to resolve scores that differ by more than one point. **Teachers may *not* score their own students' answer papers.** The scoring coordinator will be responsible for coordinating the movement of papers, calculating a final score for each student's essay or response, and recording that information on the student's answer paper.

Schools are not permitted to rescore any of the open-ended questions on any Regents Exam after each question has been rated the required number of times as specified in the rating guide, regardless of the final exam score. Schools are required to ensure that the raw scores have been added correctly and that the resulting scale score has been determined accurately.



New York State Regents Examination in English Language Arts

Part 2 Rubric

Writing From Sources: Argument

Criteria	6 Essays at this Level:	5 Essays at this Level:	4 Essays at this Level:	3 Essays at this Level:	2 Essays at this Level:	1 Essays at this Level:
Content and Analysis: the extent to which the essay conveys complex ideas and information clearly and accurately in order to support claims in an analysis of the texts	-introduce a precise and insightful claim, as directed by the task -demonstrate in-depth and insightful analysis of the texts, as necessary to support the claim and to distinguish the claim from alternate or opposing claims	-introduce a precise and thoughtful claim, as directed by the task -demonstrate thorough analysis of the texts, as necessary to support the claim and to distinguish the claim from alternate or opposing claims	-introduce a precise claim, as directed by the task -demonstrate appropriate and accurate analysis of the texts, as necessary to support the claim and to distinguish the claim from alternate or opposing claims	-introduce a reasonable claim, as directed by the task -demonstrate some analysis of the texts, but insufficiently distinguish the claim from alternate or opposing claims	-introduce a claim -demonstrate confused or unclear analysis of the texts, failing to distinguish the claim from alternate or opposing claims	-do not introduce a claim -do not demonstrate analysis of the texts
Command of Evidence: the extent to which the essay presents evidence from the provided texts to support analysis	-present ideas fully and thoughtfully, making highly effective use of a wide range of specific and relevant evidence to support analysis -demonstrate proper citation of sources to avoid plagiarism when dealing with direct quotes and paraphrased material	-present ideas clearly and accurately, making effective use of specific and relevant evidence to support analysis -demonstrate proper citation of sources to avoid plagiarism when dealing with direct quotes and paraphrased material	-present ideas sufficiently, making adequate use of specific and relevant evidence to support analysis -demonstrate proper citation of sources to avoid plagiarism when dealing with direct quotes and paraphrased material	-present ideas briefly, making use of some specific and relevant evidence to support analysis -demonstrate inconsistent citation of sources to avoid plagiarism when dealing with direct quotes and paraphrased material	-present ideas inconsistently and/or inaccurately, in an attempt to support analysis, making use of some evidence that may be irrelevant -demonstrate little use of citations to avoid plagiarism when dealing with direct quotes and paraphrased material	-present little or no evidence from the texts -do not make use of citations
Coherence, Organization, and Style: the extent to which the essay logically organizes complex ideas, concepts, and information using formal style and precise language	-exhibit skillful organization of ideas and information to create a cohesive and coherent essay -establish and maintain a formal style, using sophisticated language and structure	-exhibit logical organization of ideas and information to create a cohesive and coherent essay -establish and maintain a formal style, using fluent and precise language and sound structure	-exhibit acceptable organization of ideas and information to create a coherent essay -establish and maintain a formal style, using precise and appropriate language and structure	-exhibit some organization of ideas and information to create a mostly coherent essay -establish but fail to maintain a formal style, using primarily basic language and structure	-exhibit inconsistent organization of ideas and information, failing to create a coherent essay -lack a formal style, using some language that is inappropriate or imprecise	-exhibit little organization of ideas and information -are minimal, making assessment unreliable -use language that is predominantly incoherent, inappropriate, or copied directly from the task or texts
Control of Conventions: the extent to which the essay demonstrates command of conventions of standard English grammar, usage, capitalization, punctuation, and spelling	-demonstrate control of conventions with essentially no errors, even with sophisticated language	-demonstrate control of conventions, exhibiting occasional errors only when using sophisticated language	-demonstrate partial control of conventions, exhibiting occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension	-demonstrate emerging control of conventions, exhibiting occasional errors that hinder comprehension	-demonstrate a lack of control of conventions, exhibiting frequent errors that make comprehension difficult	-are minimal, making assessment of conventions unreliable

- An essay that addresses fewer texts than required by the task can be scored no higher than a 3.
- An essay that is a personal response and makes little or no reference to the task or texts can be scored no higher than a 1.
- An essay that is totally copied from the task and/or texts with no original student writing must be scored a 0.
- An essay that is totally unrelated to the task, illegible, incoherent, blank, or unrecognizable as English must be scored a 0.

As technology has advanced over the years, one of the more popular developments has come in the form of social media. This form of communication system, whether it be Facebook, Instagram, X or some similar platform, now plays a major role in the lives of individuals and their posts are "out there" for all to see. As a result, many employers are looking at the posts of job applicants to determine whether or not they are suitable for the position they are applying for. Despite some feeling this practice is acceptable and beneficial as a determining factor in hiring employees, in reality, it is an invasion of one's privacy, can be misleading, can lead to discrimination and is completely unnecessary.

At first glance, this practice of employers turning to an applicant's social media posts as part of the decision making process regarding the potential hiring of said applicant sounds like a good idea. Yes, what is publicly posted becomes "fair game". Yes, it may reveal "patterns of overt anger, suggestions of violence, associations with questionable characters, signs of crass behavior or even too many political posts" (Text 1, lines 18-25) which seem contrary to the expectations and image desired by the employer. However, what one sees may not be a true reflection of the individual in question. A post may have been an impulsive reaction to another's aggravating posts or a bit of humorous commentary that gets lost in the printed word, lacking the vocal intonations that would have clarified the intent. As a result, what an employer takes from such posts may be misleading and

lead to a misinterpretation of the applicant's true character and abilities. Because of this, several states such as New York and California "have enacted laws prohibiting employers from discriminating on the basis of an employee's lawful off-duty conduct" (Text 3, Lines 31-34). These states recognize that individuals' posts are part of their private lives and are not intended for professional use. Not only can this invasion of privacy be misleading and lead to misinterpretations, but it can also lead to biases.

As Jennifer Preston, an HR consultant with Flex HR points out, "while social media channels can yield ample benefits... for vetting job candidates, consulting such sources can also be risky... particularly when they are used to evaluate candidates based on their personal lives, [and] opinions" which "can create dangerous biases that can lead to legal risks" (Text 2, Lines 14-19). This is further supported by business litigation attorney Mary Allen Murray who concedes that this practice of employers looking at an applicant's social posts is legal and can "reveal a more honest view" (Text 2, Lines 20-22). However, she cautions that they may "be sued if any unlawful prejudice is shown... during the recruitment process" (Text 2, Lines 27-29). Thus the law, overall, is on the side of individual rights, and against the violation of such. An applicant's gender identity, religious and/or political beliefs, ethnicity, and personal associations should have no bearing on whether they are hired or not. These are not reflections of their work ethic or abilities. Rather, what should be taken into account is the applicant's appropriate skills, education, and prior employment, as well as how they present

themselves in a face to face interview. Applicants should only be judged on job qualifications and their personal life should remain just that - personal.

While, yes, as noted earlier, there are some benefits to an employer using an applicant's social media posts as part of the hiring process, it is clear that this process should not be allowed. Social media posts can easily be misinterpreted and, thus, misleading and for various reasons may not always be reflecting an applicant's true character. It also may lead to unfair biases, whether consciously or unconsciously, which have no bearing on the applicant's actual work ethic or qualifications for the job being applied for. As a result, an employer may miss out on an excellent employee, and an applicant may be wrongly denied a desired job opportunity.

Anchor Level 6–A

CONTENT AND ANALYSIS:

- The essay introduces a precise and insightful claim, as directed by the task (*Despite some feeling this practice is acceptable and beneficial ... it is an invasion of one's privacy, can be misleading, can lead to discrimination and is completely unnecessary*).
- The essay demonstrates in-depth and insightful analysis of the texts, as necessary to support the claim (*what an employer takes from such posts may be misleading and lead to a misinterpretation of the applicant's true character and abilities and These states recognize that individuals' posts are part of their private lives and are not intended for professional use*) and to distinguish the claim from alternate or opposing claims (*At first glance, this practice of employers turning to an applicant's social media posts as part of the decision making process regarding the potential hiring of said applicant sounds like a good idea*).

COMMAND OF EVIDENCE:

- The essay presents ideas fully and thoughtfully, making highly effective use of a wide range of specific and relevant evidence to support analysis (*Yes, it may reveal "patterns of overt anger, suggestions of violence, associations with questionable characters, signs of crass behavior or even too many political posts" ... which seem contrary to the expectations and image desired by the employer and New York and California "have enacted laws prohibiting employers from discriminating on the basis of an employee's lawful off-duty conduct"*).
- The essay demonstrates proper citation of sources to avoid plagiarism when dealing with direct quotes and paraphrased material [(Text 1, Lines 18–25), (Text 3, Lines 31–34), (Text 2, Lines 14–19)].

COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE:

- The essay exhibits skillful organization of ideas and information to create a cohesive and coherent essay, with an opening paragraph that provides background to the issue and establishes a negative claim, followed by a paragraph that addresses the counterclaim through a discussion about how information that is gained from social media, when used for professional purposes, can be seen as an *invasion of privacy* and can *lead to misinterpretations and biases*, followed by a paragraph that focuses on the legal issues that arise when biases are formed and concluding with a paragraph of summation (*Social media posts can easily be misinterpreted, and, thus, misleading and for various reasons may not always be reflecting an applicant's true character*).
- The essay establishes and maintains a formal style, using sophisticated language and structure (*A post may have been an impulsive reaction to another's aggravating posts or a bit of humorous commentary that gets lost in the printed word, lacking the vocal intonations that would have clarified the intent and Rather, what should be taken into account is the applicant's appropriate skills, education, and prior employment, as well as how they present themselves in a face to face interview*).

CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS:

- The essay demonstrates control of conventions with essentially no errors (*decision making process; their personal life*).

As the world becomes a more digital place, online presence is increasingly more relevant in one's life. Employers are beginning to utilize social media more and more to gain a more honest perspective of who their potential candidates are; but this is not a bad thing. Employers should consider social media activity when evaluating interviewees. Social media is where people project the most public version of themselves. ~~So~~ Why shouldn't employers know what one is putting out into the world? It affects their business as well.

When employers research candidates for a job, they are looking for both bad but also good qualities. Of course they want to be aware of someone's illegal activities if there are any, and possible "...patterns of overt anger, suggestions of violence, associations with questionable characters, signs of crass behavior or even too many political posts" (Text 1 line 23-24). The last item may be controversial, but different companies may wish to express specific political views, so it is completely valid to take political beliefs into consideration. A business's employees represent their ideals, so employers should know if they will taint their reputation or not. As more audiences turn to the internet for

information, they will find the same things employers have found, and therefore digital footprint matters when hiring. But if employers are going to search one up anyway, why not use that to one's advantage? "The Harris Poll surveyed over 1,000 employers and found that 67 percent of them look for information that supports a candidate's qualifications to get them through the door." (Text 4 line 24-26). If employers are looking for pros in a post, that should be an advantage. If an effort is made to project ^{deeper, more} positive qualities instead of shallow things such as beauty, this scary background check shouldn't seem so bad. If someone had nothing to hide, social media checks would be, the majority of the time, a resume boost, not a liability.

However, some may say laborers are entitled to their own private leisurely activities, which is true. They claim that it invades their privacy and crosses a line to research their life outside of work very closely. Luckily there are laws meant to protect workers. For example, "Many states have enacted laws prohibiting employers from discriminating on the basis of an employee's lawful off-duty

conduct..." (Text 3 line 31-33), meaning workers can be allowed to have lives outside work, and so long as it is legal, employers can't hold it against them. But when you think about it, why would employers be upset their workers have fun? Hanging out with friends or partying is a great way to de-stress, and as long as one displays responsibility and reliability as well, social media screenings should not worry them.

Overall, social media checks seem scary and personal at first, but being mindful of the image you project should be a concern for everyone anyway. Humanity is just starting a greater transition to ~~being~~ an age of technological reliance. Digital footprint is becoming even more accessible and public. Posting is now a mini international broadcast. Since people are viewing your social media as a representation of you, make it the best version of you. You shouldn't be ashamed of your social media ~~to~~ reaching anyone. Let's put it this way: if you wouldn't want your grandma to see it, don't post it!

Anchor Level 6–B

CONTENT AND ANALYSIS:

- The essay introduces a precise and insightful claim, as directed by the task (*Employers should consider social media activity when evaluating interviewees. Social media is where people project the most public version of themselves. Why shouldn't employers know what one is putting out into the world? It affects their business as well*).
- The essay demonstrates in-depth and insightful analysis of the texts as necessary to support the claim (*The last item may be controversial, but different companies may wish to express specific political views, so it is completely valid to take political beliefs into consideration and If someone had nothing to hide, social media checks would be, the majority of the time, a resume boost, not a liability*) and to distinguish the claim from alternate or opposing claims (*However, some may say laborers are entitled to their own private leisurely activities*).

COMMAND OF EVIDENCE:

- The essay presents ideas fully and thoughtfully, making highly effective use of a wide range of specific and relevant evidence to support analysis (*"Of course they want to be aware of someone's ... patterns of overt anger, suggestions of violence, associations with questionable characters, signs of crass behavior or even too many political posts"* and *"Many states have enacted laws prohibiting employers from discriminating on the basis of an employee's lawful off-duty conduct"*).
- The essay demonstrates proper citation of sources to avoid plagiarism when dealing with direct quotes and paraphrased material [(Text 1 line 23–24) and (Text 4 line 24–26)].

COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE:

- The essay exhibits skillful organization of ideas and information to create a cohesive and coherent essay, with an opening paragraph that introduces that *social media activity* should be considered by employers, followed by a paragraph of support that focuses on the employer's right to use social media since *a businesses employees represent* that business, and a third paragraph that addresses the counterclaim regarding *privacy* concerns, and a conclusion that advises prospective employees to be *mindful of the image you project*.
- The essay establishes and maintains a formal style, using fluent and precise language and sound structure (*As more audiences turn to the internet for information, they will find the same things employers have found, and therefore digital footprint matters when hiring and Humanity is just starting a greater transition to an age of technological reliance*), although some phrasing is less formal at times (*search one up and hanging out ... or partying*).

CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS:

- The essay demonstrates control of conventions, exhibiting occasional errors (*are; but, interviewees, beliefs; businesses employees; and therefore digital; Luckily there; veiwing*) only when using sophisticated language.

Throughout the world, social media use has constantly been increasing as more and more people start to express themselves online. As a result, the question of whether employers should consider social media activity when evaluating potential candidates has been raised. Although many may believe ^{that social media channels can create benefits for evaluating} ~~that social media activity should be considered~~ potential candidates, ~~because of legal risks and the possible risk of discrimination, this method of candidate evaluation should not be considered.~~

Because of the possible risk of discrimination, the use of social media to evaluate candidates should not be considered. According to one of the articles, the information that employers may find from consulting such sources "can also be risky", because they "can create dangerous liaisons" ~~(Text 2, line 1a)~~ ^(Text 2, line 1a). While conducting background checks using social media, employers are exposed to the personal lives of candidates but also "ethnicity, religious beliefs, gender," (Text 2, lines 25-26) and more, which can cause many to show unlawful prejudice during the recruitment process. Additionally, one example of a case in which discrimination was shown towards potential candidates was the Gaskell v. University of Kentucky case, in which the top candidate was ruled out because of the "information about the employee's religious beliefs the employer discovered through an online search" (Text 3, lines 24-25). In this case, the use of social media created an unfair discrimination towards the candidate, showing how the use of social media can ultimately lead to discrimination from employers. Because of the potential risk of discrimination, social media should not be used to consider candidates, evident from the already existing ~~the~~ cases resulting from this idea.

Additionally, social media use to consider candidates should not be used because of several laws it violates and the legal risks as a result. One example for this is the "lawful off-duty conduct law." ^(Text 3, line 31) While using social media as evaluation may not violate this law, it is very close

Anchor Paper – Part 2 – Level 5 – A

to it, and can even cause a ^(Text 3, line 32) "discriminating on the basis of an employee's lawful off duty conduct. Although personal activities may be protected by this law, the use of social media to evaluate candidates invades the personal lives of many people, causing social media to not be a good way to evaluate job candidates.

However, in contrast, many may believe that social media can be used to evaluate candidates. According to one of the articles, social media can "eliminate potential risk" (Text 1, line 35) by observing to see if social media revelations "don't affect their performance or raise any waves with coworkers" (Text 1, line 40). Employees may argue that social media reveals the best of worst of candidates, ~~and~~ allowing them to "[gain] insight on [their] candidates" (Text 2, line 12).

Although this may be true, ~~however, that is not the best about~~ ~~the risks~~ the risks employees take by taking this step to check the background of their candidate using social media is extremely excessive, as many legal issues can be caused along with discrimination against subjects.

While some may believe that social media should be used to evaluate job candidates, because of legal risks and discrimination, social media should not be considered to evaluate these people. ~~Discrimination is not legal.~~
Social media ~~posts~~ can create legal risks against laws that protect citizens and discrimination, which is why, ultimately, it should not be used ~~to evaluate~~ as a method of ~~the~~ the employee + process.

Anchor Level 5–A

CONTENT AND ANALYSIS:

- The essay introduces a precise and insightful claim, as directed by the task (*Although many may believe that social media channels can create benefits for evaluating potential candidates, because of legal risks and the possible risk of discrimination, this method of candidate evaluation should not be considered*).
- The essay demonstrates thorough analysis of the texts, as necessary to support the claim (*In this case, the use of social media created an unfair discrimination towards the candidate, showing how the use of social media can ultimately lead to discrimination from employers and Although personal activities may be protected by the law, the use of social media to evaluate candidates invades the personal lives of many people*) and to distinguish the claim from alternate or opposing claims (*However, in contrast, many may believe that social media can be used to evaluate candidates*).

COMMAND OF EVIDENCE:

- The essay presents ideas clearly and accurately, making effective use of specific and relevant evidence to support analysis (*the information that employers may find ... “can also be risky”, because they “can create dangerous biases”; the top candidate was ruled out because of the “information about the employee’s religious beliefs the employer discovered through an online search”; by observing to see if social media revelations “don’t affect their performance or raise any issues with coworkers”*).
- The essay demonstrates proper citation of sources to avoid plagiarism when dealing with direct quotes and paraphrased material [(Text 2, Lines 25–26) and (Text 1, Line 35)].

COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE:

- The essay exhibits skillful organization of ideas and information to create a cohesive and coherent essay, with an opening paragraph that introduces the issue and a negative claim, followed by two supporting paragraphs that focus on the concerns involving discrimination (*Because of the possible risk of discrimination, the use of social media to evaluate candidates should not be considered*) and the legal risks. A fourth paragraph addresses the counterclaim and is followed by a concluding paragraph that reinforces the claim (*Social media can create legal risks against laws that protect citizens and discrimination which is why, ultimately, it should not be used as a method of the employment process*).
- The essay establishes and maintains a formal style, using fluent and precise language and sound structure (*While using social media as evaluation may not violate this law, it runs very close to it, and can even cause “discriminating on the basis of an employee’s lawful off-duty conduct”*), with occasional breaks in precision (*for for “of” and a singular use of an ampersand*)

CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS:

- The essay demonstrates control of conventions, exhibiting occasional errors (*candidates, evident; “discriminating ... conduct. Although; revelations; coworkers*) only when using sophisticated language.

When applying for a job, it is important to remember that employers will judge not only the interview, but the social media presence as well. The things candidates post online are ~~another~~ a major reason why they may be declined an offer. While scary for applicants, this process is beneficial to the business, since it proves whether or not someone is responsible enough for the job.

This is a completely fair process, as it reveals who someone portrays themselves as in an online setting. In text 1, reasons are given as to why an individual may be turned down: "...patterns of overt anger, suggestions of violence, associations with questionable characters, signs of cross behavior or even too many political posts." (Text 1, lines 23-24) The reasons highlighted are all very fair; it is challenging to work with a ticking time-bomb of a person, and thus, better for the company to turn them down, rather than ignore the behavior for the innocent interview facade. Despite this, there are still risks to relying on this information. Every employer is not a saint looking for dangerous activity; they may be looking for details like race, sexuality, religion, etc, and feel inclined to deny based on what they dislike. Text 3 references two court cases where discrimination was a key factor to the employment process, "...top candidate passed over partly due to information about an employee's religious beliefs," (Text 3, lines 23-24) "...expressed a preference for white female employees..." (Text 3, lines 27-28) It is completely unfair to decide employers this way, many employers have bias or prejudice that they should not rely on for hiring potential candidates. Although there are risks, it is hard to argue that there is no benefit to looking in to outside sources for candidate information. Jeff Williams in text two conveys the right idea for how all employers should apply this process in their environment, "a good practice is for hiring managers to ask themselves what information is necessary to make a good decision..." (Text 2, lines 32-33) Managers need to really look at profiles with an unbiased eye, and truthfully find what

really matters. ~~It~~ ~~is~~ Regardless of how charismatic someone may seem, it is important to find their hidden details. For instance, ~~if~~ ~~an~~ ~~employee~~ ~~meets~~ someone who seems like the perfect teacher without checking their profiles, they could later discover that the teacher they hired speaks about their students in an inappropriate way, or wishes to cause harm to them. Despite unfortunate prejudice, it is too significant to ignore that employees cannot judge an interviewer off first impressions.

While this process seems risky or flawed, the benefits can save a company from dangerous workers. It is important that employers are an unbiased party, so they can make proper decisions for the workplace.

Anchor Level 5–B

CONTENT AND ANALYSIS:

- The essay introduces a precise and thoughtful claim, as directed by the task (*this process is beneficial to the business, since it proves whether or not someone is responsible enough for the job*).
- The essay demonstrates thorough analysis of the texts, as necessary to support the claim (*The reasons highlighted are all very fair, it is challenging to work with a ticking time-bomb of a person, and thus, better for the company to turn them down and Managers need to really look at profiles with an unbiased eye, and truthfully find what really matters*) and to distinguish the claim from alternate or opposing claims (*Despite this, there are still risks in relying on this information*).

COMMAND OF EVIDENCE:

- The essay presents ideas clearly and accurately, making effective use of specific and relevant evidence to support analysis (*reasons are given ... “patterns of overt anger, suggestions of violence, associations with questionable characters, signs of crass behavior or even too many political posts” and “a good practice is for hiring managers to ask themselves what information is necessary to make a good decision... ”*).
- The essay demonstrates proper citation of sources to avoid plagiarism when dealing with direct quotes and paraphrased material [(Text 1, lines 23–24) and (Text 3, lines 27–28)].

COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE:

- The essay exhibits logical organization of ideas and information to create a cohesive and coherent essay, with an opening paragraph that introduces a positive claim, followed by a lengthy paragraph that moves from support of the claim to presenting and refuting a counterclaim and then to *the right idea for how all employers should apply this process* of evaluating potential job candidates, and a conclusion of summation.
- The essay establishes and maintains a formal style, using fluent and precise language and sound structure (*they may be looking for details ... and feel inclined to deny based on what they dislike and Despite unfortunate prejudice, it is too significant to ignore that employers cannot judge ... off first impressions. While this process seems risky or flawed, the benefits can save a company from dangerous workers*) although it is sometimes inexact (*to decide employees and employers cannot judge an interviewer*).

CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS:

- The essay demonstrates partial control of conventions, exhibiting occasional errors (*business, since; fair, it is; person, and thus, better; this way, many; looking in to; environment, “a good*) that do not hinder comprehension.

~~Why is social media important to us and our future?~~ Why is social media important to us and our future? Over the past decade or so, the growing use of social media has led to the rise of its popularity where people share their opinions, beliefs and occasionally their lives. The more people share online, the more information about that person is online. Whether the posts are good or not, companies still have access to this, and ~~many~~ some employers use this information in the hiring process. Employers should not consider social media activity when evaluating potential candidates because the candidates can be discriminated against for their views and accessing the candidates social media accounts can have legal risks.

Social media ~~activity can lead to discrimination~~ browsing during the hiring process can lead a candidate to be discriminated against. When agents or employers browse through the candidates social media, they have access to "content available to the public" (Text 1, line 19) or even "posts you've made on social media over the past six months (even the posts you deleted)." (Text 1, lines 19-20) People often post their views and opinions on social media and with agents having access to this, they are likely to develop bias, and can discriminate against candidates for having opposing views. With this information being available, "it is difficult to prove that they were not influenced" (Text 3, line 20) when in the hiring process.

~~Why is social media important to us and our future?~~ This is important because

the more information that is accessed, the more the agent or recruiter can judge a candidate on, especially with their ethnicity, religious practices, political views, etc. Thus, not using social media during the hiring process will ~~ex~~ eliminate potential bias and discrimination.

It is also important to be aware of the legal risks associated with ~~the~~ companies having access to candidates / employees social media accounts. ~~It is not for a company~~ While employers ~~are~~ are not violating any laws by looking at an applicants interests or values, there must be "Written Consent from the prospective employee or current employee." (Text 3, line 64) This is important to acknowledge because without consent, employees would be violating laws. In addition, a legal risk of asking for an applicant's or employees password creates a "risk of violating the federal Stored Communications Act." (Text 3, line 68) This is extremely significant because this act applies to all 50 states and accessing passwords can violate ~~an~~ Act that protects employees and their rights.

~~Others~~ Others may argue that employers should consider social media activity when evaluating potential candidates because they can access information not known during the interview process. While this may be the case, accessing candidates personal views can lead to

A person being rejected because of what was found on social media. A study found that "55 percent of employers who use social media screenings said they found content that caused them not to hire a candidate." (Text 4, lines 32-33) It is likely that these individuals got rejected because they were discriminated against "ethnicity, religious beliefs, gender, or other protected classes." (Text 2 lines 25-26) This portrays how employers ~~are~~ are quick to perceive opinions about what they find online, which often causes them to reject candidates.

Overall, employers should not consider social media activity when evaluating candidates as this can eliminate discrimination, bias, and legal risks. While there are ample amounts of information online there are tons of more risks associated with using social media to evaluate a candidate.

Anchor Level 4–A

CONTENT AND ANALYSIS:

- The essay introduces a precise and thoughtful claim, as directed by the task (*Employers should not consider social media activity when evaluating potential candidates because the candidates can be discriminated against for their views and accessing the candidates social media accounts can have legal risks*).
- The essay demonstrates appropriate and accurate analysis of the texts, as necessary to support the claim (*with agents having access to this, they are likely to develop bias, and can discriminate against candidates for having opposing views and It is also important to be aware of the legal risks*) and to distinguish the claim from alternate or opposing claims (*Others may argue that employers should consider social media activity ... because they can access information not known during the interview process*).

COMMAND OF EVIDENCE:

- The essay presents ideas sufficiently, making adequate use of specific and relevant evidence to support analysis (*they have access to “content available to the public” ... or even “posts you’ve made on social media over the past six months (even the posts you deleted and With this information ... “it is difficult to prove that they were not influenced” ... when in the hiring process*).
- The essay demonstrates proper citation of sources to avoid plagiarism when dealing with direct quotes and paraphrased material [(Text 1, lines 19–20) and (Text 4, lines 32–33)].

COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE:

- The essay exhibits acceptable organization of ideas and information to create a cohesive and coherent essay, with an opening paragraph that introduces a claim against the use of social media in hiring, followed by two supportive paragraphs that focus on *discrimination* and *legal risks*. A fourth paragraph presents and refutes a counterclaim based upon the issue of employers’ rights to access *candidates personal views*, and a conclusion that restates the claim.
- The essay establishes and maintains a formal style, using precise and appropriate language and structure (*Thus, not using social media during the hiring process will eliminate potential bias and discrimination and This portrays how employers are quick to perceive opinions about what they find online, which often causes them to reject candidates*).

CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS:

- The essay demonstrates partial control of conventions, exhibiting occasional errors (*candidates social media; bias, and can; on especially; applicants interests; employee.*” (Text 3, line 54) *This; an Act that*) that do not hinder comprehension.

Anchor Paper – Part 2 – Level 4 – B

Employers should consider social media activity when evaluating potential candidates. Social media is a system that is based on communication for individuals to connect online. It is an easy access for many, through computers and cell phones. There are many different apps where you could send messages, photographs and videos.

Some people would say employers should consider social media activity when evaluating candidates because it would help employers get an idea of who that person is and would help employers make it easy to determine the skills and qualifications for that person's position. In text 1, lines 13 and 22, it explains how looking at a candidate's social media posting can help them look out for what they do or don't want. "A candidate's ironic, aggressive and potentially threatening postings are about many are on the lookout for..." "A recent survey found that 57% of employers have found social content that caused them to rule out a candidate." These quotes from text 1 helps people/employers know what they are looking for. In text 3, line 5 it states how looking through social media is helpful when determining skills for the position. "It's not unreasonable to wish to use social media to understand a prospective employee's professional qualifications and skills to determine the fit for the position." This quote from text 3 backs up the opinion on employers should check social medias for candidates.

Others may disagree and argue that employers shouldn't consider social media activity when evaluating potential candidates. They would disagree because, At times when checking social media content, it creates biased opinions that affect the choosing for the position like a past, negative comment or post can stick. In text 2, lines 17-19 it explains how biased opinions are created when checking social media causing a negative outcome for candidates. "Particularly when they are used to evaluate candidates based on their personal lives, opinions and what they choose to post and re-post..."

Anchor Paper – Part 2 – Level 4 – B

Information can create dangerous biases that can lead to legal risks? In text 4, lines 13-14 and 32-33, it describes how Social Media from Past Posts can negatively disqualify you. "Just one negative impression from your social media profile could disqualify you from a position." "A whopping 55% of employers who use social media screenings said that they have found content causing them not to hire a candidate." Based on these quotes from text 4 and 2, people will argue that checking candidates social media often have a negative outcome based on negative opinions.

In conclusion, Although many argue both sides. Employers should consider social media activity when evaluating possible candidates because it gives opinions and expectations for the position.

Anchor Level 4–B

CONTENT AND ANALYSIS:

- The essay introduces a precise claim as directed by the task (*Employers should consider social media activity when evaluating potential candidates ... because it would help employers get an idea of who that person is and ... make it easy to determine the skills and Qualifications for that Persons Position*).
- The essay demonstrates some analysis of the texts (*These Quotes from text 1 helps people/employers know what they are looking for* and *This Quote from text 3 backs up the opinion on if employers should check social medias for candidates*), but distinguishes the claim from alternate or opposing claims (*Others may disagree and argue that employers shouldn't consider social media activity when evaluating potential candidates*).

COMMAND OF EVIDENCE:

- The essay presents ideas sufficiently, making adequate use of specific and relevant evidence to support analysis (*"A candidate's irate, aggressive and potentially threatening postings are what many are on the look out for ..."* and *"Just one negative impression from your social media profile could disqualify you from a position"*).
- The essay demonstrates inconsistent citation of sources to avoid plagiarism when dealing with direct quotes and paraphrased material with some accurate citations (*In text 2, lines 17–19 it explains* and *In text 4, lines 13–14 and 32–33, it describes*) although in other situations line numbers indicated are not fully inclusive of the quotes referenced or are missing and miscopying occurs in some instances.

COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE:

- The essay exhibits acceptable organization of ideas and information to create a mostly coherent essay, first introducing a claim, then supporting the claim with one body paragraph that focuses on reasons why employers should use social media to evaluate candidates, followed by a second body paragraph that addresses an opposing claim that focuses on biases that create a *Negative outcome* for the candidate, and concluding with the consideration that *many argue both sides* and a reiteration of the claim.
- The essay establishes but fails to maintain a formal style, using primarily basic language and structure (*These Quotes from text 1 helps people/employers know what they are looking for; Based on these Quotes from text 4 and 2, people will argue; Although many argue both sides*).

CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS:

- The essay demonstrates partial control of conventions, exhibiting occasional errors (*many, through; persons position; dont; Quotes ... helps; because, At; conent; a past, Negative; checking ... often have; conclusion, Although ... sides. Employers*) that do not hinder comprehension.